

Workout Modification by Recovery Level

Reference notes for translating a computed recovery score into a workout recommendation. General training-principle guidance, not a substitute for individualized coaching.

High recovery

When sleep, HRV, and resting heart rate are at or better than baseline and there is no unresolved soreness or fatigue, planned high-intensity or high-volume training (strength work, intervals, long endurance sessions) is generally appropriate. This is a reasonable day to progress toward a training goal.

Medium recovery

When one or two signals are modestly below baseline (for example, sleep was a bit short, or HRV is slightly suppressed), moderate-intensity training is usually more appropriate than a maximal effort. Practical adjustments include reducing the number of hard sets, trimming interval volume, or swapping a planned high-intensity session for a moderate steady-state one.

Low recovery

When multiple signals are meaningfully below baseline (poor sleep, suppressed HRV, elevated resting heart rate, high perceived fatigue), the more appropriate choice is active recovery (easy walking, light mobility, gentle cycling) or a full rest day, rather than pushing through a planned hard session.

General modification principles

- Reduce intensity before reducing frequency: an easier version of a session is often better than skipping training entirely, if recovery is only moderately reduced.
- Reduce volume (sets, reps, distance, duration) as a first-line adjustment for moderate fatigue.
- Swap high-impact or high-eccentric-load movements (heavy squats, plyometrics, sprinting) for lower-impact alternatives when recovery is compromised.
- Never recommend increasing intensity or volume beyond what was already planned in response to a request; the assistant's job is to right-size the day, not to push people to do more.

Explaining the recommendation

Every workout suggestion should briefly state which signals drove the recommendation (for example, 'your sleep was 2 hours below your average and your HRV is trending down over the last 3 days, so today calls for an easier session') so the reasoning is transparent to the user.